

Month 1

Soul Food Break*fast

Snack Pack

Created By: Dr. D Brown



Foundation in Christ | Youth Edition
One Month's Worth of Lessons

SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY SERIES

Break · fast - Month 1

Youth Edition

 Theme:

Part I: Prayer, the First Resort

“In nothing be anxious, but in everything, by prayer and petition with thanksgiving, let your requests be made known to God.” — Philippians 4:6 (WEB)

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This book is designed as a Bible study and devotional resource. It is not intended to replace professional counseling, pastoral covering, medical care, or legal/financial advice. Readers are encouraged to seek appropriate professional help when needed and to remain connected to a Bible-believing local church.

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DEDICATION

This work is dedicated first and foremost to the Lord Jesus Christ—the original Disruptor, the Living Word, and the true Bread of Life. May every page point you back to Him.

To my son, Jafari, you pushed me to be a better mom and a teacher of the Word. Seeing your excitement and hearing how you and the youth I've taught rallied around the message—recalling with energy the impact of every lesson—is why this playbook exists. You are the reason I keep refining the craft.

To the student reading this: you aren't just a face in the crowd or a number to God. You are the guest of honor at His table. If you've ever felt like "leftovers" or found yourself stuck on a "loading screen" in life, know that you aren't too young to lead or too late for His promises. Don't settle for vibes when God is offering you Vision. You aren't just the future; you are the power of the church right now.

To the mentors, teachers, and real ones grinding behind the scenes—the ones praying for this generation and showing up even when it's hard: your "yes" is the soil this work grew from. Your unseen sacrifices are building a legacy that no book could ever fully describe.

Now, it's time to level up. This series is your foundation—designed to help you make prayer your first resort, navigate the "art of through," and move with the faith and foresight of a Kingdom builder. Keep dreaming, keep pushing, and stay hungry for the Word. The Shepherd is leading, and the win is already yours.

"Let no man despise thy youth; but be thou an example of the believers, in word, in conversation, in charity, in spirit, in faith, in purity." — 1 Timothy 4:12 (KJV)

With warm regards,

Dr. Dee Brown

Creator, SOFU Bible Study Series

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QUICK START FOR LEADERS

Who this is for:

Pastors, ministers, small group leaders, Sunday school teachers, and facilitators using the Soul Food Series in any gathering (church, home, online, or community setting).

Session Length & Rhythm

- Recommended session time: 60–75 minutes
- Ideal pace: 1 lesson per week (or biweekly for deeper processing)
- Group size: 4–15 people works best.

Basic Flow for Each Lesson

1. Welcome & Prayer (5–10 min)
2. Appetizer (10–15 min)
3. Main Course: Bites + CST (30–35 min)
4. Dessert & To-Go Box (10–15 min)
5. Closing Prayer (5 min)

Tips for Leading Well

- Create a safe space; remind the group that what is shared stays in the group (w/ appropriate exceptions for safety).
- Honor time by starting and ending close to schedule.
- Let the Holy Spirit lead; the questions are a guide, not a cage.
- Model honesty and vulnerability.
- Invite participation, not performance.

Using Activities & Games

Use Trivia Mix-Up (Millionaire-style) and Tricky Testaments (Jeopardy-style) as openers to review the previous lesson or as closers to reinforce the current one. Let youth or emerging leaders help read questions, track scores, or lead a round to build ownership and confidence.

Before Each Session

- Read the Background Text and lesson in advance.
- (Optional) Play the audio companion track.
- Pray for wisdom, discernment, and sensitivity.
- Ask God who might need extra encouragement that day.

You don't have to be a Bible scholar to lead. You just have to be willing, teachable, and available. God will take care of the rest.

PROLOGUE

“Prayer for Divine Connection”



In the quiet of my heart, I seek Your face,
Elohim, Jesus Christ, fountain of grace.
Through ancient paths where prophets once trod,
I reach beyond the veil to touch my God.

Your Word, a lamp that guides through darkest night,
Transforms my weakness into holy might.
The Holy Spirit breathes where faith is born,
Three persons, one God—Father, Spirit, Son.

In perfect unity, the Trinity divine,
The Comforter within, Your presence mine.
The body of Christ, united as one,
Brother and sister beneath Your sun.

In family ties, both blood and spirit-bound,
Your kingdom's strength on earth is found.
When others stumble, empathy extends my hand,
With sympathy I weep, I pray, I stand.

The Spirit intercedes with groans too deep for words,
An advocate whose whisper's always heard.
For we are woven in Your love's design,
Each thread of mercy, wholly Thine.

Through sacrifice You broke sin's heavy chain,
Now in Your presence, I am born again.
The Spirit seals us, marked as heaven's own,
Until we stand before the eternal throne.

-By S.L. Doctor

Introduction – “Prayer, the First Resort”

“Be careful for nothing; but in every thing by prayer and supplication with thanksgiving let your requests be made known unto God.” — Philippians 4:6 (KJV)

Life will try to rush you. Stress will try to speak first. Fear will try to grab the microphone. But Philippians 4:6 gives us a different plan: **pray first**. Prayer isn’t what you do after you’ve tried everything else—it’s the **first resort** that walks you into God’s presence before anxiety walks you into panic.

Prayer isn’t a religious routine or “pretty words.” It’s real communication with a real God. You’re not informing Him—He already knows. You’re inviting Him into the center of your thoughts, your decisions, your relationships, your pressure, and your future. Prayer is how you stop carrying everything alone and start moving with faith.

This month, we’re learning prayer through four real-life examples that match what you’re facing right now:

- **Esther** — Don’t rush it; pray and fast first, then move with courage.
- **Solomon** — When God says “Ask,” don’t chase stuff—ask for wisdom.
- **Jesus** — God honors consistent communication with Him.
- **Paul & Silas** — Your present circumstances don’t have to define you; prayer and praise break chains.

So as we start Month 1, let prayer be your first escort—before the group chat, before the breakdown, before the plan. Because when you learn to pray first, you don’t just get answers... you get **peace, direction**, and a stronger walk with God.

SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY

Breakfast Edition Month 1 – Esther

Second *IS* the Best

 **Theme:** God can use you even when you feel like the “backup plan.”

 **Background Text:** Esther 1–4 (focus on chapters 2–4)

 **Key Verse: Esther 4:14 (WEB)**

“For if you remain silent now, then relief and deliverance will come to the Jews from another place, but you and your father’s house will perish. **Who knows if you haven’t come to the kingdom for such a time as this?**”

Appetizer – Esther’s Unexpected Crown, Esther 2:17 (WEB)

“The king loved Esther more than all the women, and she obtained favor and kindness in his sight more than all the virgins; so that he set the royal crown on her head, and made her queen instead of Vashti.”

Esther didn’t grow up dreaming of being queen. She was a Jewish orphan, raised by her cousin Mordecai, living in a foreign empire. But when Queen Vashti was removed, a search went out—and Esther was chosen. People might’ve seen her as “second pick,” but God saw her as **perfectly placed**.

Reflection Question

Have you ever felt like you were only chosen because someone else messed up or said no?

Main Course

Bite 1 – A Scary Choice, Esther 4:13–14 (WEB)

“Then Mordecai asked them to return this answer to Esther: ‘Don’t think to yourself that you will escape in the king’s house any more than all the Jews. For if you remain silent now, then relief and deliverance will come to the Jews from another place, but you and your father’s house will perish. **Who knows if you haven’t come to the kingdom for such a time as this?**’”

Mordecai tells Esther the truth:

- She can’t hide behind her crown.
- She has a choice—**stay silent**, or **speak up** and risk her life.
He also shows faith: even if Esther stays quiet, God will still send help from somewhere. But she might miss her assignment.

Reflection Question

Where in your life might you be tempted to stay silent when you know God wants you to speak or act?

Bite 2 – Fasting Before the Move, Esther 4:16 (WEB)

“Go, gather together all the Jews who are present in Susa, and **fast for me**, and neither eat nor drink three days, night or day. I also and my maidens will fast in the same way. Then I will go in to the king, which is against the law; and if I perish, I perish.”

Esther doesn’t rush in on her own strength. She:

- Calls for **three days of fasting** (no food, no drink) for all the Jews in the city.
- Joins in the fast with her attendants.
- Decides: “If I perish, I perish.” That’s not drama—that’s surrender.

Reflection Question

What's one situation in your life where you need to **pray and maybe fast** before you make a big move?

Bite 3 – Purpose in the Palace, Esther 8:7–8 (WEB)

“Then King Ahasuerus said to Esther the queen and to Mordecai the Jew, ‘See, I have given Esther the house of Haman, and they have hanged him on the gallows because he laid his hand on the Jews. Write also to the Jews, as it pleases you, in the king’s name, and seal it with the king’s ring; for the writing which is written in the king’s name, and sealed with the king’s ring, may no man reverse.’”

God flips the script:

- The enemy (Haman) is removed.
- Esther and Mordecai are given authority to write a new decree to protect their people.
- The same system that almost killed them is used to **defend** them.

Reflection Question

Have you ever seen God turn something that was supposed to hurt you into something that helped you or others?

Dessert

Esther's story reminds us:

- You're not “just” a backup.
- God can use where you are, even if you didn't choose how you got there.

Reflection Question

Complete this: “God, if You put me **here**, help me to _____.”

To-Go Box

- Your position is not an accident—it can be an **assignment**.
- Fasting and prayer prepare you for scary obedience.
- God can use your “second place” to bring a **first-class** victory for many people.

Write one sentence:

“Lord, help me see my current situation as **purpose**, not just **pressure**.”

Prayer

“Lord, thank You for Esther. Help me not to see myself as ‘second best’ when You call me chosen and placed. Give me courage to obey You even when it scares me, and teach me to pray and fast instead of panicking. Use my life to help others, ‘for such a time as this.’ In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Personal Prayer Space

Write your own short prayer about where you think God has placed you “for such a time as this”:

Activity – Quick Review

Fill in the blanks using what you’ve learned:

1. Esther became queen **instead of** _____.
2. Her cousin who raised her was named _____.
3. Mordecai told her she had come to the kingdom **for such a** _____ **as this**.
4. Before going to the king, Esther asked the Jews to _____ for three days.

Word Study

“King Ahasuerus” = Xerxes in some translations.

“Shushan” = Susa.

Practical counsel on fasting (consult pastor/doctor as applicable).

Notes Section & Group Discussion

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BM1 — Lesson 2: Solomon

Wisdom in Response

 **Theme:** Prayer, the First Resort

 **Background Text:** 1 Kings 3:5–14; 2 Chronicles 1:7–12; 1 Kings 4:29–30

 **Key Verse:** 1 Kings 3:9 (WEB)

“Give your servant therefore an understanding heart to judge your people, that I may discern between good and evil; for who is able to judge this your great people?”

Appetizer – When God Says, “Ask Me for Anything”, 1 Kings 3:5–7 (WEB)

⁵ In Gibeon Yahweh appeared to Solomon in a dream by night; and God said, “Ask for what you want me to give you.” ⁶ Solomon said, “You have shown to your servant David my father great loving kindness, according as he walked before you in truth, righteousness, and uprightness of heart with you. You have kept for him this great loving kindness, that you have given him a son to sit on his throne, as it is today.

⁷ Now, Yahweh my God, you have made your servant king instead of David my father. I am just a little child. I don’t know how to go out or come in.

Solomon has just become king. God appears to him in a dream and basically says, “What do you want Me to give you?” Instead of pretending he has it all together, Solomon admits he feels young and unsure.

Reflection Question

If God asked you, “What do you want Me to give you?” What would your honest first answer be?

Main Course

Bite 1 – What’s Really in Your Heart, 1 Kings 3:8–9 (WEB)

⁸ Your servant is among your people which you have chosen, a great people, that can’t be counted nor numbered for multitude. ⁹ Give your servant therefore an understanding heart to judge your people, that I may discern between good and evil; for who is able to judge this great people of yours?

Instead of asking for more money, more power, or revenge on his enemies, Solomon asks for an **understanding heart** so he can lead God’s people well. What he asks for shows what matters most to him.

Reflection Question

What do your prayers say about what you care about most?

Bite 2 – God’s Response, 1 Kings 3:10–12 (WEB)

¹⁰ This request pleased the Lord, that Solomon had asked this thing. ¹¹ God said to him, “Because you have asked this thing, and have not asked for yourself long life, nor have asked riches for yourself, nor have asked the life of your enemies, but have asked for yourself understanding to discern justice, ¹² behold, I have done according to your word. Behold, I have given you a wise and understanding heart, so that there has been no one like you before you, and after you none will arise like you.

God is **pleased** with Solomon’s request. He gives Solomon the wisdom he asked for, and later adds riches and honor too. God loves when we want what He wants—especially when we ask for wisdom to serve others.

Reflection Question

Where in your life do you most need God’s wisdom right now—school, friendships, money, family, decisions?

Bite 3 – Learning to Seek Wisdom, Proverbs 2:1–6 (WEB)

¹ My son, if you will receive my words, and store up my commandments within you, ² so as to turn your ear to wisdom, and apply your heart to understanding; ³ yes, if you call out for discernment, and lift up your voice for understanding; ⁴ if you seek her as silver, and search for her as for hidden treasures: ⁵ then you will understand the fear of Yahweh, and find the knowledge of God. ⁶ For Yahweh gives wisdom. Out of his mouth comes knowledge and understanding.

Later, Solomon teaches others how to chase wisdom. Wisdom isn't something you sit around and wait for—it's something you **seek like treasure**. Real wisdom comes from God.

Reflection Question

What is one practical way you can start “seeking wisdom like treasure” this week?

Dessert

Solomon's story reminds us:

- What we ask God for shows what's in our heart.
- God loves to give wisdom to people who want to use it His way.

Reflection Question

Finish this quietly: “Lord, help me want _____ more than _____.”

To-Go Box

- God isn't just listening to **what** you ask—He sees **why** you ask.
- Wisdom is worth more than status or stuff.
- When you don't know what to do, asking God for an **understanding heart** is one of the best prayers you can pray.

Write one sentence:

“God, please give me wisdom about _____.”

Prayer

“God, thank You for the way You answered Solomon when he asked for wisdom. Please forgive me for the times I chase stuff more than I chase Your heart. Give me an understanding heart to make good choices, treat people right, and honor You in my decisions. Help me to seek wisdom like treasure. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Personal Prayer Space

Write your own short prayer asking God for wisdom in a real situation you’re facing:

Activity – “Ask Big” (Youth)

Fill in the blanks from the lesson:

1. God appeared to _____ in a dream and said, “Ask for what you want Me to give you.”
2. Solomon asked for an _____ **heart** to judge God’s people.
3. God was _____ that Solomon asked for wisdom instead of riches or revenge.
4. In Proverbs 2, we are told to seek _____ like silver and hidden treasure.

BM1 – Lesson 3: Jesus

Prayer as the First Resort

 **Theme:** Talking to God before everything falls apart

 **Background Text:** Luke 5:15–16; Luke 11:1–4; Luke 18:1–8

 **Key Verse:** **Luke 18:1 (WEB)**

“He also spoke a parable to them that they must always pray, and not give up;”

Appetizer – Jesus Pulled Away to Pray, Luke 5:15–16 (WEB)

¹⁵ But the report concerning him spread much more, and great multitudes came together to hear, and to be healed by him of their infirmities. ¹⁶ But he withdrew himself into the desert, and prayed.

Crowds kept coming. Needs kept growing. People wanted to hear Jesus and be healed. But instead of just doing more and more, Jesus **chose to pull away and pray**. When things got busier, He didn’t pray less—He prayed **more**.

Reflection Question

When your life gets busier or more stressful, what usually gets cut first: sleep, fun, prayer, or something else?

Main Course

Bite 1 – “Lord, Teach Us to Pray”, Luke 11:1–4 (WEB)

¹ When he finished praying in a certain place, one of his disciples said to him,
“Lord, teach us to pray, just as John also taught his disciples.”

² He said to them, “When you pray, say,
‘Our Father in heaven, may your name be kept holy.
May your Kingdom come.

May your will be done on earth, as it is in heaven.

³ Give us day by day our daily bread.

⁴ Forgive us our sins, for we ourselves also forgive everyone

who is indebted to us. Bring us not into temptation,
but deliver us from the evil one.’ ”

The disciples watched Jesus pray and **wanted that**, not just a script.

Jesus gives them a pattern:

- Start with **who God is** (Father, holy, His Kingdom)
- Ask for **daily needs**
- Ask for **forgiveness** and help to forgive others
- Ask for help in **temptation**

Reflection Question

Which part of that prayer do you use most—praise, daily needs, forgiveness, or help in temptation? Which part do you usually skip?

Bite 2 – Don’t Quit Praying, Luke 18:1–5 (WEB)

¹ He also spoke a parable to them that they must always pray, and not give up, ² saying, “There was a judge in a certain city who didn’t fear God, and didn’t respect man. ³ A widow was in that city, and she often came to him, saying, ‘Defend me from my adversary!’

⁴ He wouldn’t for a while; but afterward he said to himself, ‘Though I neither fear God, nor respect man, ⁵ yet because this widow bothers me, I will defend her, or else she will wear me out by her continual coming.’

Jesus tells a story about a judge who doesn’t care about God or people. A widow keeps coming anyway, asking for justice. The judge finally responds—not because he’s good, but because she **doesn’t quit**.

Jesus uses this to show: if even a bad judge listens to persistence, how much more will a **good God** listen to His kids?

Reflection Question

Is there something you used to pray about that you’ve stopped praying for because it took too long?

Bite 3 – God Is Not Like the Unjust Judge, Luke 18:6–8 (WEB)

⁶The Lord said, “Listen to what the unrighteous judge says. ⁷Won’t God avenge his chosen ones, who are crying out to him day and night, and yet he exercises patience with them? ⁸I tell you that he will avenge them quickly. Nevertheless, when the Son of Man comes, will he find faith on the earth?”

Jesus makes the contrast clear:

- God is not like an unjust judge.
- God **hears** His people crying out day and night.
- The question isn’t “Will God answer?” It’s “Will we still have **faith** when He does?”

Reflection Question

What does it look like—for you—to “always pray and not give up” about one thing this week?

Dessert

Jesus’ life says:

- Prayer isn’t just something we do **when all else fails**.
- Prayer is how we **breathe with God**—daily, honestly, persistently.

Reflection Question

Finish this: “From now on, when I feel overwhelmed, I want to **pray first** instead of _____.”

To-Go Box

- If Jesus needed to pull away and pray, we definitely do too.
- Prayer is simple: talk to God, listen, and keep coming back.
- Not every prayer gets answered the way we expect—but **no prayer is ignored**.

Write one sentence:

“Jesus, help me remember to talk to You **before** I _____.”

Prayer

“Jesus, thank You for showing us what real prayer looks like. Forgive me for the times I only pray when I’m desperate. Help me to come to You first—not last. Teach me to pray simply, honestly, and consistently, and not to give up when I don’t see answers right away. In Your name, amen.”

Activity – “First Response Check” (Youth)

Fill in:

1. One thing that stresses me out: _____
2. My usual first response (be honest): _____
3. A new first response I want to try: **Pray before I** _____.

(Answers are personal; no key needed in the student book—only in your heart.)

BM1 – Lesson 4: Paul & Silas

Faith in the Dark

 **Theme:** Praising God when life feels unfair

 **Background Text:** Acts 16:16–34

Key Verse: Acts 16:25 (WEB)

“But about midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the prisoners were listening to them.”

Appetizer – Doing Right and Still Getting Hurt, Acts 16:22–24 (WEB)

²² The multitude rose up together against them, and the magistrates tore their clothes off of them, and commanded them to be beaten with rods.²³ When they had laid many stripes on them, they threw them into prison, charging the jailer to keep them safely, ²⁴ who, having received such a command, threw them into the inner prison, and secured their feet in the stocks.

Paul and Silas helped set a slave girl free from a spirit that was controlling her.

Instead of getting a “thank you,” they were:

- Stripped
- Beaten
- Thrown into the **inner prison**
- Locked in stocks

They were in pain for doing the **right** thing.

Reflection Question

How do you usually react when you get in trouble or get hurt for doing something right?

Main Course

Bite 1 – Midnight Praise, Acts 16:25 (WEB)

“But about midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the prisoners were listening to them.”

At their worst moment—midnight, in pain, chained—they choose to:

- Pray
- Sing hymns to God

Everyone else is listening. Their worship turns the prison into a **sanctuary**.

Reflection Question

If someone listened to you in your “midnight moments,” what would they hear—complaints, silence, or praise?

Bite 2 – The Shaking, Acts 16:26–28 (WEB)

²⁶ Suddenly there was a great earthquake, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken; and immediately all the doors were opened and everyone’s bonds were loosened. ²⁷ The jailer, being awakened out of his sleep and seeing the prison doors open, drew his sword and was about to kill himself, supposing that the prisoners had escaped. ²⁸ But Paul cried with a loud voice, saying, “Don’t harm yourself, for we are all here!”

God answers in a wild way:

- Earthquake
- Open doors
- Loose chains

But the first miracle Paul and Silas walk in is **self-control**. They stay, not because they’re stuck, but because they see the jailer’s life is on the line.

Reflection Question

What does it say about Paul and Silas that they cared more about the jailer’s life than their own escape?

Bite 3 – From Prison to Baptism, Acts 16:29–34 (WEB)

²⁹ He called for lights, sprang in, fell down trembling before Paul and Silas, ³⁰ and brought them out and said, “Sirs, what must I do to be saved?” ³¹ They said, “Believe in the Lord Jesus Christ, and you will be saved, you and your household.” ³² They spoke the word of the Lord to him, and to all who were in his house. ³³ He took them the same hour of the night and washed their stripes, and was immediately baptized, he and all his household. ³⁴ He brought them up into his house and set food before them, and rejoiced greatly, with all his household, having believed in God.

Because Paul and Silas stayed:

- The jailer falls down and asks how to be saved.
- He and his whole family hear about Jesus.
- That same night they were **baptized**.
- The jailer washes the wounds of the same men he once guarded.

Their pain became the door to someone else’s **salvation**.

Reflection Question

Can you think of a time when God used something hard in your life to help or encourage someone else?

Dessert

Paul and Silas show us:

- You can be in a dark place **and** still choose faith.
- God can turn a prison into a place of praise and a place of salvation.

Reflection Question

Complete this: “God, in my dark moments, help me to choose _____ instead of _____.”

To-Go Box

- Doing the right thing doesn't always lead to easy places, but God is still there.
- Your worship in hard times is louder than you think—people are listening.
- God can use your midnight to bring someone else into the light.

Write _____ one _____ sentence:

“Lord, help me remember that You are still with me even when I feel _____.”

Prayer

“Lord, thank You for Paul and Silas. When life feels unfair or dark, remind me that You are still worthy of praise. Help me not to give up on You when things hurt. Use my faith in tough times to point other people to You. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Personal Prayer Space

Write a short prayer about a “midnight” area in your life where you want to trust God more:

Activity – “Midnight Playlist”

Write down:

1. One worship song that helps you trust God when you're sad or stressed:

2. One verse from this lesson (or another) you can hold onto in a dark time:

3. You can use these as your “**midnight tools**” the next time things feel heavy.

 Notes Section — Group Discussion & Personal Study

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Appendix – Breakfast Month 1 (YE) Answer Key

Theme: Prayer, the First Resort

Lesson 1 – Esther: Second Is the Best

1. Vashti
2. Mordecai
3. time
4. Fast

Lesson 2 - Solomon: Wisdom in Response

1. God appeared to Solomon in a dream and said, “Ask for what you want Me to give you.”
2. Solomon asked for an understanding heart to judge God’s people.
3. God was pleased that Solomon asked for wisdom instead of riches or revenge.
4. In Proverbs 2, we are told to seek wisdom like silver and hidden treasure.

Lesson 3 - Jesus

Activity – “First Response Check” (Youth)

(Personal responses, for open discussion ...no wrong answers)

Lesson 4 - Paul & Silas

Activity – “Midnight Playlist” (Youth)

(Personal responses, for open discussion ...no wrong answers)

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